

Errors

Sometimes programs don't work the first time, but they can always be fixed. When code for a program isn't entered correctly, Python will display an error message telling you what has gone wrong.

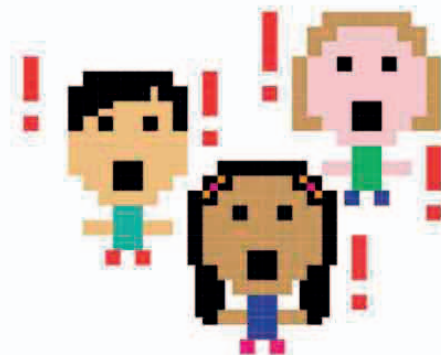
Errors in the code window

When trying to run a program in the code window, you might see a pop-up window appear with an error message (such as "SyntaxError") in it. These errors stop the program from running and need to be fixed.

SEE ALSO

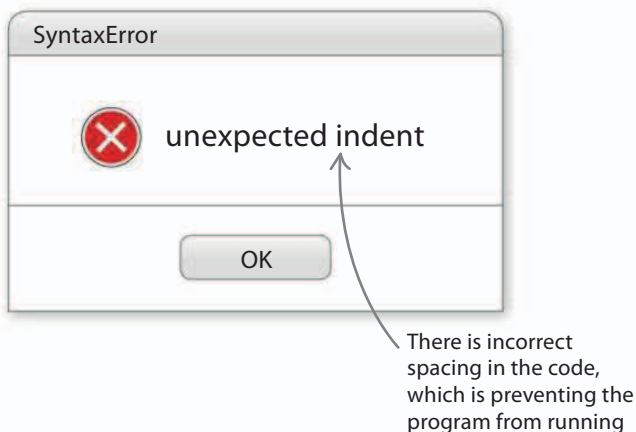
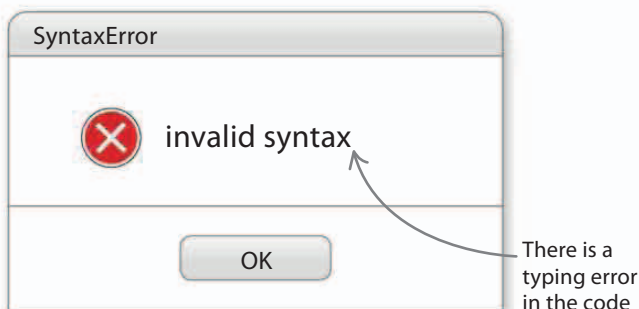
Bugs and debugging **148–149** ›

What next? **176–177** ›



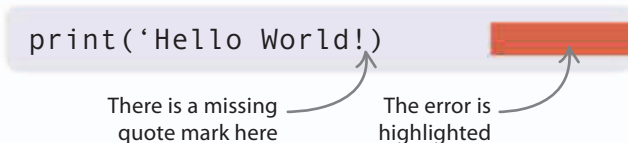
1 Syntax error

If a pop-up window appears with a "SyntaxError" message, it often means there's a spelling mistake or typing error in the code.



2 Error highlighted

Click "OK" in the pop-up window and you'll go back to your program. There will be a red highlight on or near the error. Check that line for mistakes carefully.



EXPERT TIPS

Classic errors

Some mistakes are particularly easy to make. Keep an eye out for these common problems:

Upper vs lower case: The case has to match exactly. If you write "Print" instead of "print", Python won't understand the instruction.

Single and double quotes: Don't mix up single and double quotes. All opening quotes need a matching closing quote.

Minus and underscore: Don't confuse the minus sign (-) with the underscore (_).

Different brackets: Different-shaped brackets, such as (), {}, and [], are used for different things. Use the correct ones, and check there's a complete pair.